

some of the root causes of RSI: repetition and static positions.”

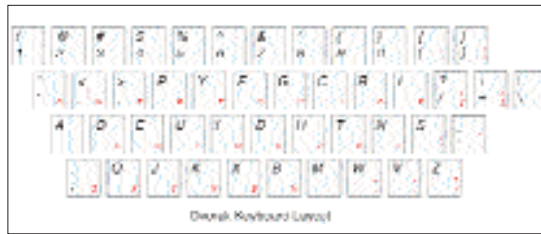
Take Your Pick

Alternative keyboards promote neutral wrist postures. They use different designs to change the user's posture. By and large, designs try to tackle the issue of wrist extension.

For instance, fixed split keyboards try to straighten the wrist by increasing the distance between the right and left sides of the keyboard so that each half is aligned with the forearm.

A complementary ergonomic mouse allows you to work comfortably for hours by keeping the hand in a neutral position. For instance, in the Logitech V500 Cordless Notebook Mouse, the patented expandable chassis articulates seven degrees to fit the hand while in use.

Then there are multi-touch fixed-angle split keyboards with a touch sensitive surface, wherein with a few finger gestures you can issue multiple commands. Multi-touch software can track and interpret the motion of several hands—and their corresponding fingers—at a time.



The Dvorak layout is an ergonomic alternative to QWERTY

In some designs, keyboards are completely split (www.kinesis.com). Vertically split keyboards require the user to type with the hands facing each other (www.safetype.com). The Orbitouch keyboard (www.keybowl.com) lets users rest their hands on two domed surfaces and then move these surfaces to generate characters. Hunt-and-peck typists may need time to get accustomed to using such keyboards; touch typists are easily able to adjust.

Increase In Productivity

Many designs result in demonstrable productivity improvements, with users improving their overall work speed.

For instance, some keyboards have one-touch buttons that take you directly to the most used programmes. By

merely pressing a single button, you can start many of your favourite media applications, navigate videos and comfortably adjust settings.

In India, Microsoft (www.microsoft.com) has introduced special curved and split keyboards in the Natural Keyboard Elite series. The keyboard is split into two, as a result, only minimal movement is needed to hit each key—and the hands move very little.

Ergonomic keyboards offer health benefits, as we've mentioned earlier. Still, the ubiquitous conventional keyboard has the largest number of takers because of its low cost.

Nevertheless, this equation will change as businesses find that ergonomically-designed input devices increase productivity and offer less risk of injury. Such devices could certainly become the norm one day.

If you spend a lot of time at your computer, a keyboard featuring cordless technology, a comfortable design and convenient controls, along with a complementary mouse may be worth the extra expense. ☒

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